

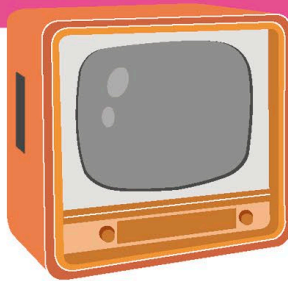
January

26

1926

Television trial

Scottish inventor John Logie Baird made the first public demonstration of television to 50 scientists at his laboratory in London, UK. The TV would later become the centre of home entertainment for millions all over the world.



Born this day

1944 Angela Davis, Black American activist and author. She took charge of the Communist Party USA and stood up for civil rights, racial equality, and women's rights.

1924

Winter gold

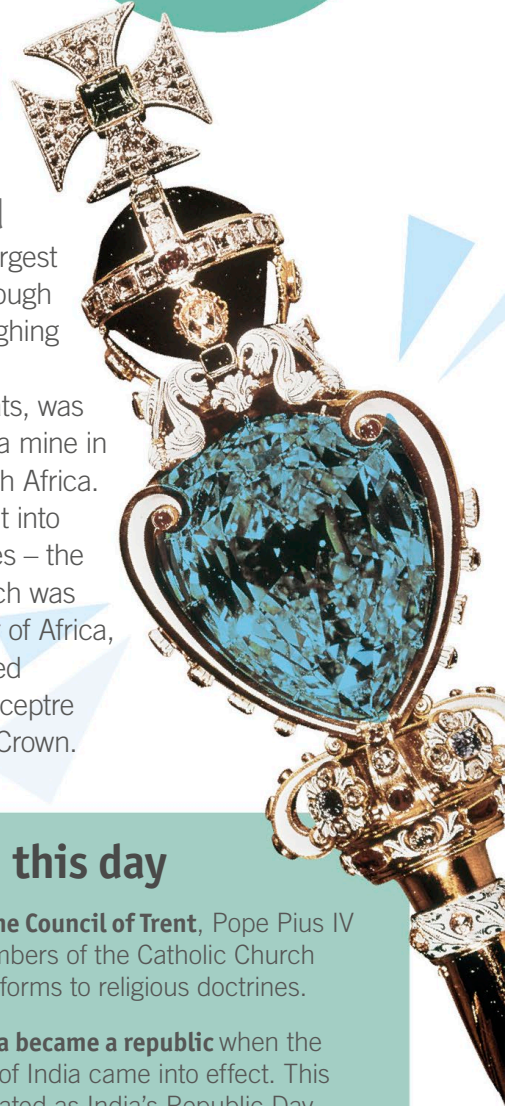
The first gold medal at the Olympic Winter Games was won by US skater Charles Jewtraw at the 500 m speed skating event held in Chamonix, France. The medal remains on display at the Smithsonian Institution in Washington, DC, USA.



1905

Cullinan Diamond

The world's largest gem-quality rough diamond, weighing a whopping 3,106.75 carats, was unearthed at a mine in Cullinan, South Africa. It was later cut into nine big pieces – the largest of which was the Great Star of Africa, now embedded in the Royal Sceptre of the British Crown.



Also on this day

1564 At the Council of Trent, Pope Pius IV and key members of the Catholic Church agreed on reforms to religious doctrines.

1950 India became a republic when the Constitution of India came into effect. This day is celebrated as India's Republic Day.

1972 Serbian flight attendant Vesna Vulović fell 10,160 m (33,330 ft) from an exploded aircraft and miraculously survived.